



Department
for Work &
Pensions

Ms J Smith
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Carer's Allowance Unit
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Your reference:

Reassessing your Carer's Allowance overpayment

Our decision

Dear Ms J Smith

We are reassessing Carer's Allowance (CA) overpayments related to employed earnings between April 2015 and September 2025. This is because our guidance on averaging earnings for carers at that time was unclear.

Why you are getting this letter

We previously told you that you were overpaid CA from:

- 24 April 2023 to 21 May 2023
- 11 December 2023 to 31 December 2023
- 11 March 2024 to 7 April 2024
- 15 April 2024 to 21 April 2024
- 29 April 2024 to 9 June 2024

After reassessing your overpayments, we have found our decision for 24 April 2023 to 21 May 2023 was incorrect. You were entitled to CA during this period, which means you were not overpaid.

This is because your earnings should have been averaged. Your average weekly earnings during this period did not go over the earnings limit.

However, your average weekly earnings for 11 December 2023 to 31 December 2023, 11 March 2024 to 7 April 2024, 15 April 2024 to

Other ways to communicate with us

If you need braille, British Sign Language, a hearing loop, translations, large print, Easy Read, audio or something else, please contact us.

If you use Relay UK dial 18001 followed by our telephone number.

Please turn over

21 April 2024, and 29 April 2024 to 9 June 2024 still went over the earnings limit. This means our decisions for these periods have not changed. The amount of CA you were asked to pay back for these periods stays the same.

What happens next

We will work out how much the amount you owe us has reduced.

We will write to you within 6 weeks when this is done.

How we reached the decision

CA has a weekly earnings limit. Because you did not receive the same amount each time you were paid, and your earnings sometimes went over the weekly limit, we have averaged your earnings for each period to get a more accurate view of your weekly earnings.

For 24 April 2023 to 21 May 2023, we calculated your average weekly earnings to be £80.09.

This was below the weekly earnings limit of £139 for 2023.

For 11 December 2023 to 31 December 2023, we calculated your average weekly earnings to be £145.

For 11 March 2024 to 7 April 2024, we calculated your average weekly earnings to be £156.50.

For 15 April 2024 to 21 April 2024, we calculated your average weekly earnings to be £162.80.

For 29 April 2024 to 9 June 2024, we calculated your average weekly earnings to be £154.50.

These were above the weekly earnings limit of £139 for 2023 and £151 for 2024.

How we calculated your average weekly earnings

For each period, we looked at your total net earnings for CA.

We work out your net earnings for CA by taking your gross pay and deducting:

- your income tax
- your National Insurance (NI)
- 50% of your pension contributions
- other expenses, like equipment needed to do your job
- alternative care costs that enable you to work

To find out how much you earned a week, we first worked out your average net monthly earnings. Then, we multiplied it by 12 to get

your average yearly earnings. Finally, we divided it by 52 to get your average weekly earnings.

Average monthly earnings x 12 ÷ 52 = average weekly earnings

When your earnings were below the weekly limit

24 April 2023 to 21 May 2023

Total gross pay	£320.36
Tax	- £0
National Insurance	- £0
50% of your pension contributions	- £0
Other expenses	- £0
Allowable care costs	- £0
Total net earnings	£320.36
Average weekly earnings	£80.09

When your earnings were above the weekly limit

11 December 2023 to 31 December 2023

Total gross pay	£450
Tax	- £0
National Insurance	- £0
50% of your pension contributions	- £0
Other expenses	- £15
Allowable care costs	- £0
Total net earnings	£435
Average weekly earnings	£145

11 March 2024 to 7 April 2024

Total gross pay	£626
Tax	- £0
National Insurance	- £0
50% of your pension contributions	- £0
Other expenses	- £0
Allowable care costs	- £0
Total net earnings	£626
Average weekly earnings	£156.50

15 April 2024 to 21 April 2024

Total gross pay	£172.80
Tax	- £0
National Insurance	- £0
50% of your pension contributions	- £0
Other expenses	- £0
Allowable care costs	- £10
Total net earnings	£162.80
Average weekly earnings	£162.80

29 April 2024 to 9 June 2024

Total gross pay	£927
Tax	- £0
National Insurance	- £0

50% of your pension contributions	- £0
Other expenses	- £0
Allowable care costs	- £0
Total net earnings	£927
Average weekly earnings	£154.50

If you would like a breakdown of your earnings and deductions for each pay date, you can call or write to us.

Yours sincerely,

Office manager

Help and support

If you would like independent advice, you can contact:

- Carers UK: <https://go.carersuk.org/OverpaymentSupport>
 - Carers Trust: www.carers.org
 - MoneyHelper: www.moneyhelper.org.uk
 - a local Citizens Advice: www.citizensadvice.org.uk
 - Civil Legal Advice: www.gov.uk/civil-legal-advice
 - StepChange Debt Charity: www.stepchange.org
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If you disagree with any of our decisions

You can ask us to explain any decision

You, or someone who has the authority to act for you, can phone or write to us within 1 month of the date on this letter to ask us to explain any of our decisions in writing.

You can ask us to explain more than 1 decision at the same time.

You can also ask us to reconsider any decision

Tell us if you have more information, or if you think we have overlooked something which might change a decision. Do this within 1 month of the date on this letter.

We will look at what you tell us and send you a letter to tell you what we have decided, and why. We call this letter a Mandatory Reconsideration Notice.

When you have done this you can appeal

If you disagree with the Mandatory Reconsideration Notice, you can appeal to a tribunal.

You must wait for the Mandatory Reconsideration Notice before you start an appeal.

Treating people fairly

We are committed to the Equality Act 2010 and treating people fairly. To find out more about this law, search 'Equality Act' on www.gov.uk

Call charges

Calls to 0800 numbers are free from personal mobiles and landlines.

Why DWP needs personal information and how we treat it

We treat personal information carefully. We may use it for any of our purposes. To learn more about information rights and how we use information, please visit our DWP Personal Information Charter at www.gov.uk/dwp/personal-information-charter